Drawing the Lines

AP Human Geography · Unit 4 · Two stimuli (like Question 3) · 7 points · Student handout · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

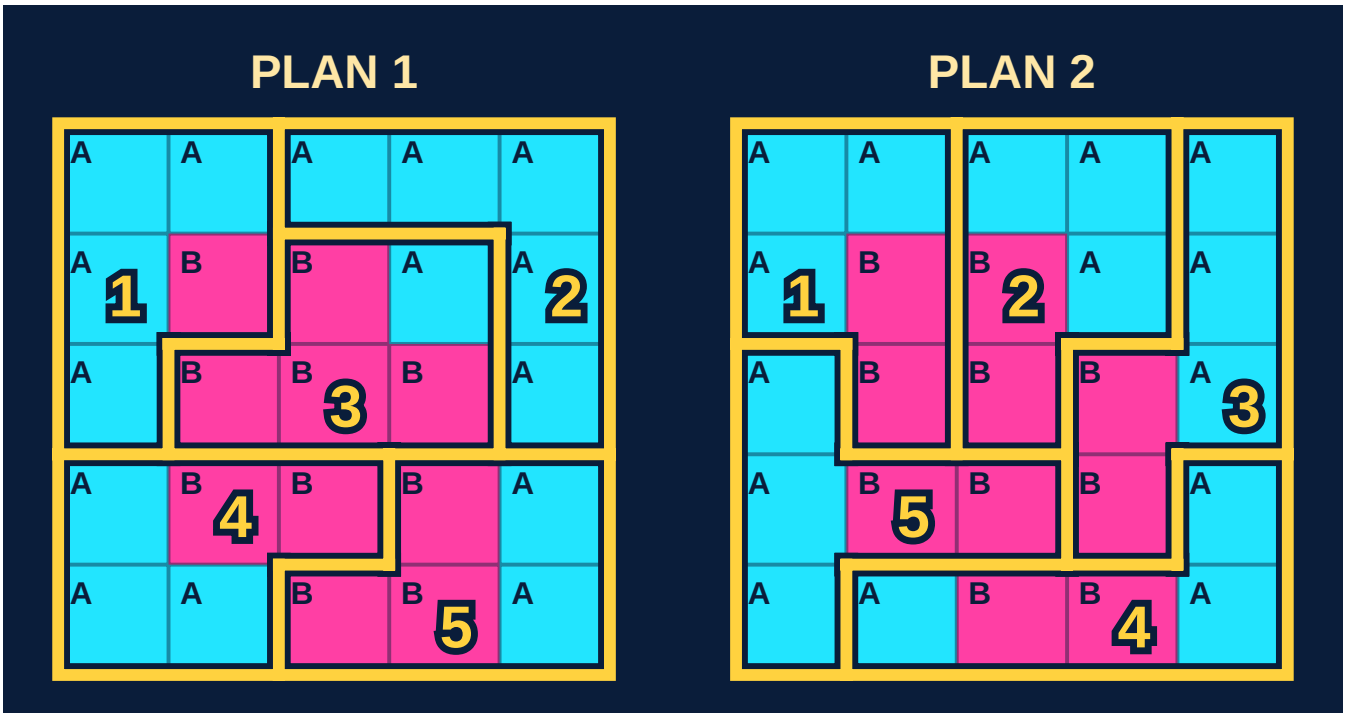
Name _____ Date _____ Period _____

Directions: Answer all parts of the question. Respond in complete sentences; an outline or bulleted list is not acceptable. Label each part (A, B, C...). For Describe and Explain parts, write it out with **T1-** (your reason in general words), **E2-** (the specific proof), and **A3-** (why it matters).

Westmoor, a fictional U.S. state, has 25 voting precincts with equal populations and 5 seats in the U.S. House of Representatives. After the census, mapmakers proposed two plans for grouping those precincts into 5 districts, using the same voters and votes.

Westmoor Redistricting: Two District Plans (Stimulus 1) and Election Results (Stimulus 2)

Stimulus 1: Two District Plans for Westmoor



Fictional state created for practice. Simplified: all 25 precincts have equal populations, and a party wins a district by winning at least 3 of its 5 precincts.

Stimulus 2: Election Results in Westmoor Under Each Plan

Result	Party A	Party B
Statewide vote share	60%	40%
Precincts won (of 25)	15	10
Districts won under Plan 1 (of 5)	3	2
Percent of seats under Plan 1	60%	40%
Districts won under Plan 2 (of 5)	5	0
Percent of seats under Plan 2	100%	0%

Fictional data created for practice. Simplified: equal-population precincts, and the same statewide vote under both plans. Remember: label each part, and write Describe and Explain parts as T1- (your reason in general words), E2- (the specific proof), A3- (why it matters).

A. Using Stimulus 1, identify the gerrymandering technique used to draw the district boundaries in Plan 2. IDENTIFY

B. Using Stimulus 1, describe how the district boundaries in Plan 2 divide Party B's voters. DESCRIBE

T1-

E2-

A3-

C. Explain why the boundaries of congressional districts in the United States are redrawn every ten years. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

D. **Using both stimuli, explain how Plan 2 produces an election result that does not match the statewide vote.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

E. **Using Stimulus 2, explain ONE effect that a districting plan like Plan 2 could have on voters or on political representation.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

F. **Explain ONE way that an independent redistricting commission OR a compactness requirement could reduce gerrymandering like the one in Plan 2.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

G. **Explain how district boundaries like those in Plan 2 could act as a centrifugal force in a country.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-